Ejbyvej 48 detecting permission report

Nov 7, 2026 · @Mark

Summary

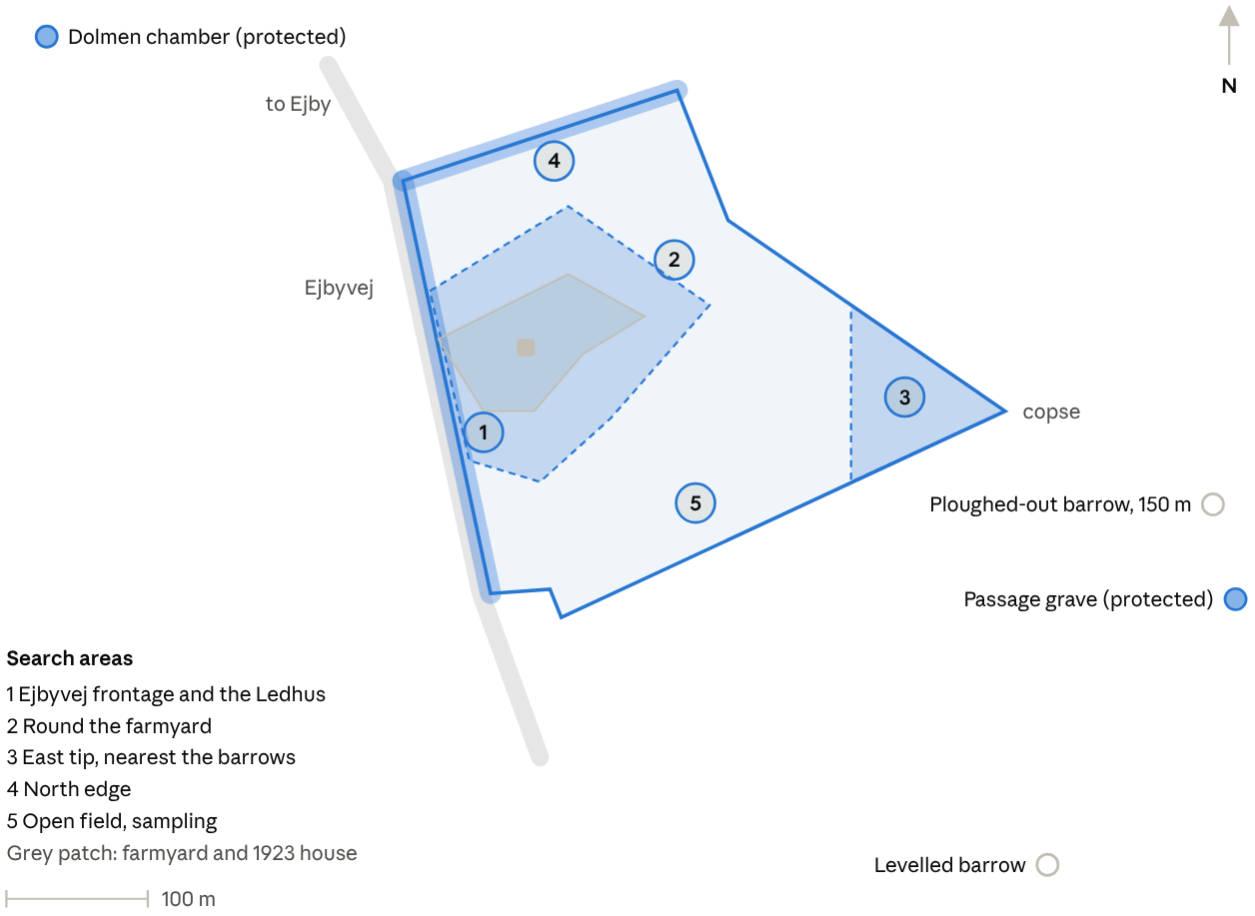
The permission is the farm at Ejbyvej 48: one parcel, matrikel 8e of Ejby By, about 8.6 ha. It is a single arable field with about 300 m of frontage on Ejbyvej, the farmyard and a farmhouse of 1923 in its west part, and a point running about 430 m east to a small copse. It lies on the south-east edge of Ejby village in Rye parish, Hornsherred, on the old road from the village towards Rye church. Both old maps print "Ledhus" beside Ejbyvej at the farm. That name usually means the house that kept the village field gate, a place everyone going to and from the fields passed. Round it lies one of the richest Bronze Age landscapes in the area. This is a strong permission. Expect 1700s to 1900s losses along the road, and keep a real eye out for Bronze Age metal.

- **Start on the Ejbyvej frontage (area 1).** The Ledhus and the gate stood by the road here on both old maps, and the road is old.
- **Then round the farmyard (area 2).** The house is 50 m in from the road, and the ground round a farm collects the most losses.
- **Then the east tip (area 3).** It is the parcel's nearest point to the barrows: a ploughed-out barrow lies about 160 m beyond it and a protected passage grave about 210 m. It probably also slopes towards the wet ground by Ejby Å.
- **No protected monuments lie on the parcel.** The nearest are that passage grave and a dolmen chamber 270 m from the north-west corner. Within about 1 km are some 25 barrows and dolmens, a Late Bronze Age scrap hoard with casting waste, a grave with a bronze sword, and a Bronze Age axe found with a detector.
- **To settle first:** whether the field is ploughed this season, and whether the owner allows digging along the road verge.

The parcel outline is traced from your hunting-app screenshot and is good to about 10 to 20 m. Positions from the archaeology register are good to about 10 to 50 m. My readings of your old-map screenshots are good to about 25 to 50 m.

Map

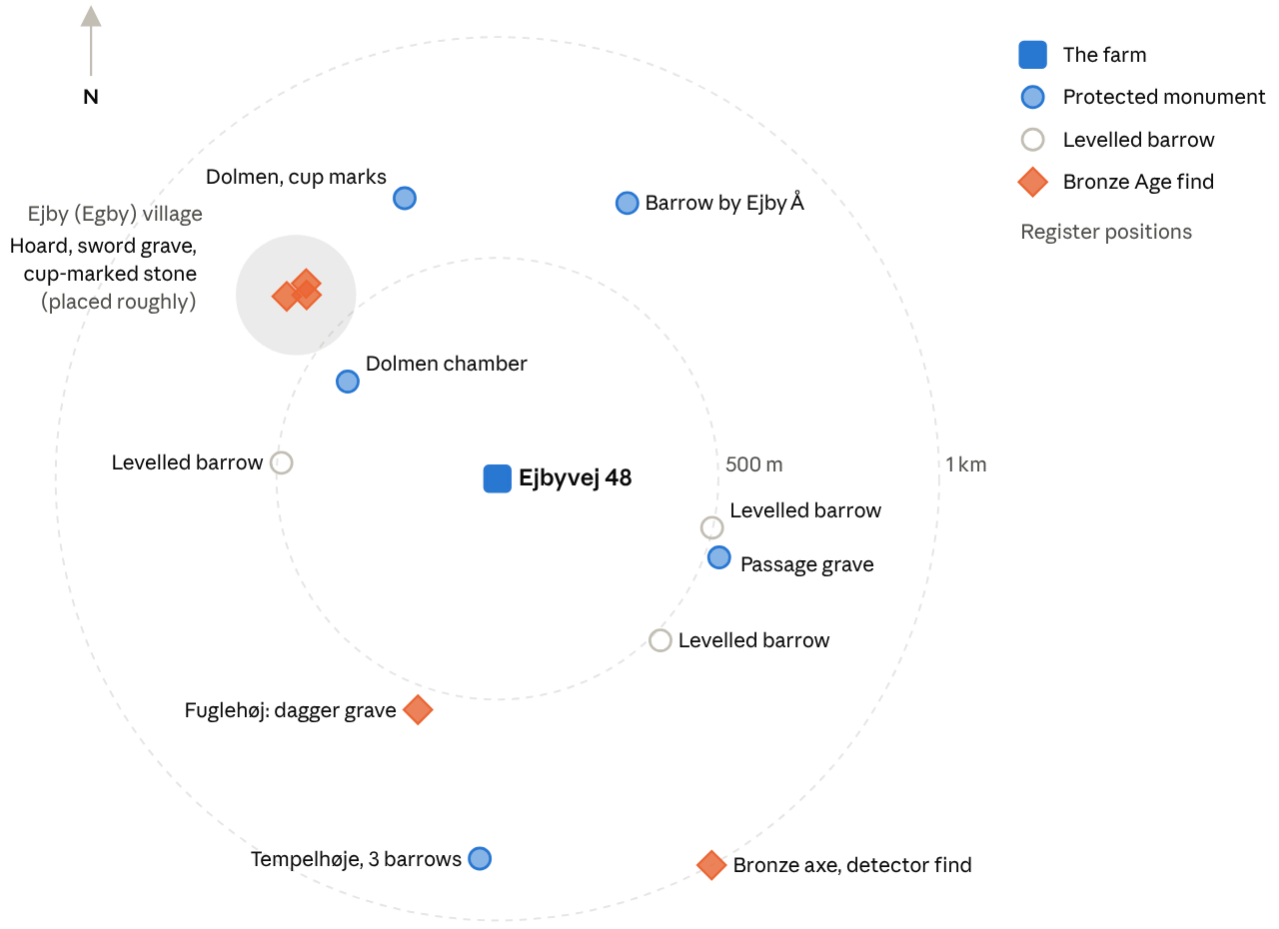
Numbers run from the first place to search (1) to the last (5); the reasons are in Areas and plan below. The outline is traced from your hunting-app screenshot.



Matrikel 8e with the five search areas

Prehistoric sites ring the farm, most 400 m to 1 km from the house

Recorded sites within about 1 km of Ejbyvej 48; north is up



Recorded sites round Ejbyvej 48, from the archaeology register

The second map shows the wider setting round the farmhouse. The Bronze Age finds cluster at Ejby village to the north-west and on the higher ground to the south and east.

Parcel	Size	Where	Today
8e, Ejby By	about 8.6 ha (85,820 m²)	East of Ejbyvej, with about 300 m of road frontage on its west side; the east tip is about 430 m from the road	One arable field with tramlines on the photo; farmyard and 1923 house in its west part; a small copse at the east tip

- **Address:** Ejbyvej 48, 4070 Kirke Hyllinge. Ejerlav Ejby By, Rye; Rye parish, Lejre Kommune.
- **Height:** about 28 m above sea level at the house.

History of the area

Ejby was a farming village on the base of Hornsherred, between Isefjord and Roskilde Fjord. The farm sits on its south-east fields, on the road that ran from the village towards Rye church and the medieval stone house at Ryegård.

- **Ejby (Egby).** Both old maps spell it Egby. The 1883 National Museum survey and the 1887 museum accession register also call the village Egby or Eiby, in Rye parish, Voldborg herred. Today it has grown into a commuter town of about 1,960 people (Wikipedia).
- **The farm.** The address register gives matrikel 8e, Ejby By, about 8.6 ha, with a brick farmhouse built in 1923 (DanskAdresseAPI). A letter after the number (8e) means the parcel was split off an older farm, number 8 of the village, probably in the late 1800s or early 1900s. The older farm's buildings may have stood elsewhere.
- **The Ledhus.** Both old maps print "Ledhus" beside Ejbyvej at the farm. Before enclosure, a Danish village fenced its fields, and roads leaving the village passed through gates (led). A ledhus was the small house at such a gate, often lived in by whoever kept it. Carts, livestock and people going to the fields all went through here.
- **The village hall and telephone.** By the 1901-71 map, Ejby had a Forsamlingshus (village hall) and a telephone exchange (Tlf st) on its south edge. Both were typical of a busy farming village around 1900.
- **Ryegård and Rye church, 1.4 km south-east.** ROMU, the Roskilde museum, dug a medieval stone house with a tile kiln west of the church in 1987-89. It is probably "the old stone house" named in a survey of 1573. In 2020 detecting there produced 132 objects declared danefæ. Detecting north of the church found Roman silver coins of Valens (364-367), coins of Christopher II, and a gilt Urnes-style brooch of the early Middle Ages.
- **The older landscape.** Hornsherred is full of dolmens, passage graves and Bronze Age barrows. Within 1 km of the farm the 1883 survey recorded about 25 mounds, most of them since ploughed out. Kirke Hyllinge, 3 to 4 km away, has a late Iron Age and Viking burial ground (Viking Ship Museum).

What the old maps show

Both maps fit today's roads closely. Ejbyvej runs on its present line on both, from Egby south-east past the farm. These readings come from your two Fund og Fortidsminder screenshots.

1842-99 map (høje målebordsblade)

- **The Ledhus.** "Ledhus" is printed beside Ejbyvej at the farm, with a small building on the road. This is the oldest sign of a building here.

- **Egby** lies to the north-west, with "Steendysse" marked at its south edge. That is the protected dolmen chamber 400 m away.
- **Long straight field boundaries** cross the road east-west. They are typical of the enclosure (udskiftning) of the village fields around 1800.
- **Ponds and marl pits** are dotted over the fields. A wet meadow and stream (Ejby Å) lie to the north-east.
- **Spot heights** of 24 to 26 m sit round the farm, rising to 32 and 36 m to the south and west, and falling to 17 m towards the stream.

1901-71 map (lave målebordsblade)

- **The Ledhus** is still printed at the farm, and several small buildings now line Ejbyvej between the farm and the village.
- **The village edge** has a Forsamlingshus and a telephone exchange (Tlf st) to the north-west.
- **Mosevang**, a farm, stands about 300 to 400 m to the north.
- **"Vad" (ford)** is printed twice on the stream to the north-east, where tracks crossed Ejby Å. Fords collect losses.
- **FM marks** (fortidsminde) show the dolmen at Egby and the passage grave to the east.
- **Dashed tracks** run off Ejbyvej to the fields on both sides.

The parcel's west side is the Ejbyvej frontage, and the farmhouse stands about 50 m in from the road. On both maps the Ledhus label sits beside the road at the farm. The gate house therefore stood either on the parcel's road edge or on the plots just across the road. Area 1 covers the parcel side.

Recorded archaeology

Nothing is recorded on the parcel. The nearest record is a ploughed-out barrow about 160 m beyond its east tip. The register holds about 25 sites within 1 km and over 60 within 1.5 km, mostly barrows and dolmens. The Bronze Age finds are the ones that matter for a detectorist. Distances are from the farmhouse; the parcel reaches about 340 m east of it.

Record	What it is	Date given	Distance
020611-81	Protected dolmen chamber, 4 uprights and a capstone, the mound ploughed away	Neolithic, 3950 to 2801 BC	400 m north-west
020611-80	Ploughed-over barrow (1883)	Prehistoric	490 m west

Record	What it is	Date given	Distance
020611-194	Ploughed-over barrow, found on the General Staff map of the early 1800s	3950 to 1101 BC	500 m east
020611-53	Levelled barrow (1883)	Prehistoric	520 m south-east
020611-17	Protected passage grave, 13 uprights, chamber 6.75 by 3 m	Neolithic, 3950 to 2801 BC	530 m east-south-east
020611-16	Fuglehøj, a levelled barrow dug in 1869: burial with a bronze dagger, a belt hook and a brooch	Bronze Age, 1500 to 1301 BC	550 m south-south-west
020611-239	Grave goods from a barrow on Ejby Mark, bought in 1887: bronze sword, two knives, a saw blade, tweezers, awls and buttons	Late Bronze Age, 1100 to 901 BC	about 600 m north-west (placed roughly)
020611-206	Large scrap hoard found digging gravel at Egby in 1887: brooch, sword blade, spearhead, axes, hanging bowl, sickle, arm rings, a pin and seven casting jets	Late Bronze Age, 1100 to 901 BC	findspot unknown; plotted in the village 620 m north-west
020611-159 / -229	Stone with about 40 cup marks and a hand sign, ploughed up in 1983 300 m north-east of Toftegården, now on Ejby green	Bronze Age	630 to 730 m north-west
020611-87	Protected ruined dolmen with cup marks on the capstone	Neolithic and Bronze Age	670 m north-north-west
020611-83	Protected barrow by Ejby Å, 15 m across	Prehistoric	690 m north-north-east
020611-13 to -15	Tempelhøje, three protected barrows in an oak wood	Prehistoric	850 m south

Record	What it is	Date given	Distance
020611-187	Bronze axe (celt) found with a detector in 2010	Late Bronze Age	1.0 km south-south-east
020611-207	Signet ring and three coins, danefæ 2014	1500 to 1900	1.2 km north-north-east
020611-188	Copper sterling of Erik of Pomerania, Næstved mint, detector find 2010	Medieval, 1400 to 1440	1.3 km north-west
020611-182	North of Rye church: Roman coins of Valens, coins of Christopher II, a gilt Urnes brooch fragment	Roman Iron Age and medieval	1.4 km south-east
020611-161	Ryegård: medieval stone house and tile kiln; 132 danefæ objects from detecting in 2020	Medieval	1.4 km south-east
020611-174	Vårkærgård Øst: a denarius of Severus Alexander (223) and a bronze coin of Theodosius II (423-425), detector finds	Roman Iron Age	1.4 km north-east

- **A Bronze Age focus.** Two graves with bronze weapons, a scrap hoard with casting waste, two cup-marked stones and a detector-found axe all lie within about 1 km. Bronze was being cast at or near Ejby around 1000 BC.
- **The hoard's findspot is lost.** It was found digging gravel "at Egby" in 1887 and placed in the village by default. Old gravel pits on higher ground near the village are where it most likely came from.
- **Detectorists have done well here.** Roman, medieval and post-medieval coins and a signet ring have been declared danefæ within 1.5 km, all found with detectors since 2003.

Areas and plan

The Ejbyvej frontage ranks first, because the Ledhus and the field gate funnelled every trip out of the village past it. Numbers match the parcel plan in Map.

Rank	Area	Why	How to search
1	The Ejbyvej frontage, the whole 300 m of the west side, about 20 m deep	Gate house (Ledhus) and field gate on both old maps; old road from Egby towards Rye church and Ryegård	Tight lanes parallel to the road, keeping off the verge drain; dig all non-ferrous
2	A band about 50 m wide round the farmyard	Losses and rubbish spread from the farm; the 1923 house may replace older buildings of farm 8	Lanes round the yard edge, working outwards until finds thin
3	The east tip, from about 230 m east of the road to the copse	Nearest point to the barrows (160 and 210 m); probably low ground towards Ejby Å	Wide lanes first. Look for burnt flint, dark patches, and any bronze; check round the copse
4	The north edge, along the boundary with the farm to the north	A straight boundary like the enclosure lines of about 1800 on the old maps	One or two lanes along the edge
5	The open middle and south of the field	Manuring scatter; the dagger grave at Fuglehøj lies about 380 m beyond the south-west corner	Wide lanes about 10 m apart, then tighten where it produces

- **The farmyard itself.** The 1923 house and yard will be full of modern iron. Leave them unless the owner wants them searched.
- **Flint.** Walk the whole field with your eyes down for worked flint, especially in areas 3 and 5. Dolmens and a passage grave lie 210 to 400 m away.

First 10 hours

1. **Hours 1 to 3: area 1.** Tight lanes about 1.5 m apart along Ejbyvej, starting level with the farm entrance and working north and south.
2. **Hours 3 to 5: area 2.** Lanes round the farmyard, working outwards.
3. **Hours 5 to 7: area 3.** Wide lanes over the east tip, then tighten round anything Bronze Age or any patch of burnt flint.
4. **Hour 7 to 8: area 4.** The north edge.
5. **Hours 8 to 9: area 5.** Wide lanes about 10 m apart across the rest, to see where finds thin out.
6. **Hour 10: go back** to the best spot and tighten the lanes.

Log every non-ferrous find with a GPS point, including buttons and scrap. Bronze casting waste looks like shapeless lumps or short rods. Bag and record it: it is easy to throw away by mistake.

What to expect

Post-medieval finds are near certain. The Bronze Age chance is better than on any of your recent permissions. The figures are my judgment from the evidence above, not measured rates.

Period	Chance of a datable find	Typical finds
1800s to early 1900s	Near certain	Skilling and øre coins, buttons, buckles, harness fittings, horseshoe fragments, lead scrap, toy soldiers
1536 to 1800	Likely	Skilling coins of Christian IV to Christian VII, lead cloth seals, thimbles, shoe buckles, a signet ring as found 1.2 km away
Medieval (about 1050 to 1536)	Possible to likely	Pennies and copper sterlings like the Erik of Pomerania find, lead weights, buckles, strap ends, legs from bronze cooking pots
Viking and late Iron Age	5 to 10%	Brooch fragments like the Urnes piece at Rye church, weights, hack silver
Roman Iron Age	5 to 15%	Roman silver and bronze coins, brooches; three such coin finds within 1.4 km
Bronze Age	15 to 25%	Axe and spearhead fragments, casting jets and lumps, pins, buttons, arm-ring pieces, knife and razor fragments
Neolithic	Surface flint likely; metal none	Flint flakes, scrapers, axe fragments

- **Bronze Age scrap.** The 1887 hoard was broken metal gathered for recasting. Odd bronze lumps, short rods and bent fragments are worth as much attention as a whole object.

- **Road and gate losses.** Coins, buttons and harness pieces should cluster along Ejbyvej and at the farm entrance.
- **Village edge.** Fields near Ejby got household rubbish spread on them, so expect modern junk towards the north-west.

Rules, limits and open questions

Rules

- **Permission.** Keep the owner's agreement current, and check it covers all of matrikel 8e.
- **Protected monuments.** Detecting is not allowed on a protected monument or within 2 m of it. None lies on the parcel; the nearest is the passage grave about 210 m beyond the east tip.
- **Danefæ and recording.** Register finds in DIME with a GPS point and the matrikel number. The responsible museum is ROMU (Roskilde Museum), which handles Lejre Kommune.
- **Depth.** Stay in the plough layer. If you meet dark soil, burnt stone, pottery, or several bronze pieces together, stop and tell ROMU. A hoard is worth more to everyone left in place.
- **Ammunition.** Leave anything suspicious and call 114.

Limits

- **The parcel outline is traced.** I traced it from your hunting-app screenshot, scaled to the registered area of 85,820 m². Corners may be 10 to 20 m out.
- **Old-map readings are mine,** from screenshots placed to about 25 to 50 m. The Ledhus may sit on the parcel or just beside it.
- **Record positions are the register's coordinates.** Records from 1869 and 1887 can be hundreds of metres out; the hoard and the sword grave have no exact findspot.
- **Trap Danmark** for Rye parish would not load, so the village history here is thinner than in your earlier reports.

Open questions

- [ ] Walk the east tip and note whether it is wet, and whether the copse hides big stones, a pit or a mound.
- [ ] Ask the owner whether the field is ploughed this season, and whether the old farm 8 stood here before the 1923 house.
- [ ] Ask the owner or Lejre local archive where the Ledhus stood and when it went.

- [ ] Check the enclosure map of Ejby (about 1790 to 1810) for the gate, the old road line and gravel pits.
- [ ] Ask ROMU or Lejre – Arkæologisk Forening whether anything more is known about where the 1887 hoard was found.

Sources

- Ejbyvej 48, DanskAdresseAPI: matrikel, ejerlav, parish, area, height and building year.
- Fund og Fortidsminder: the records linked above, pulled from its public map service.
- Ejby, Lejre Municipality, Wikipedia: location and population.
- Kirke Hyllinge, Viking Ship Museum: the Viking burial ground.
- Your hunting-app screenshot of the parcel (Septima, © KDS), your Google Maps screenshot, and your Fund og Fortidsminder screenshots of the 1842-99 and 1901-71 maps (Kort © SDFI).